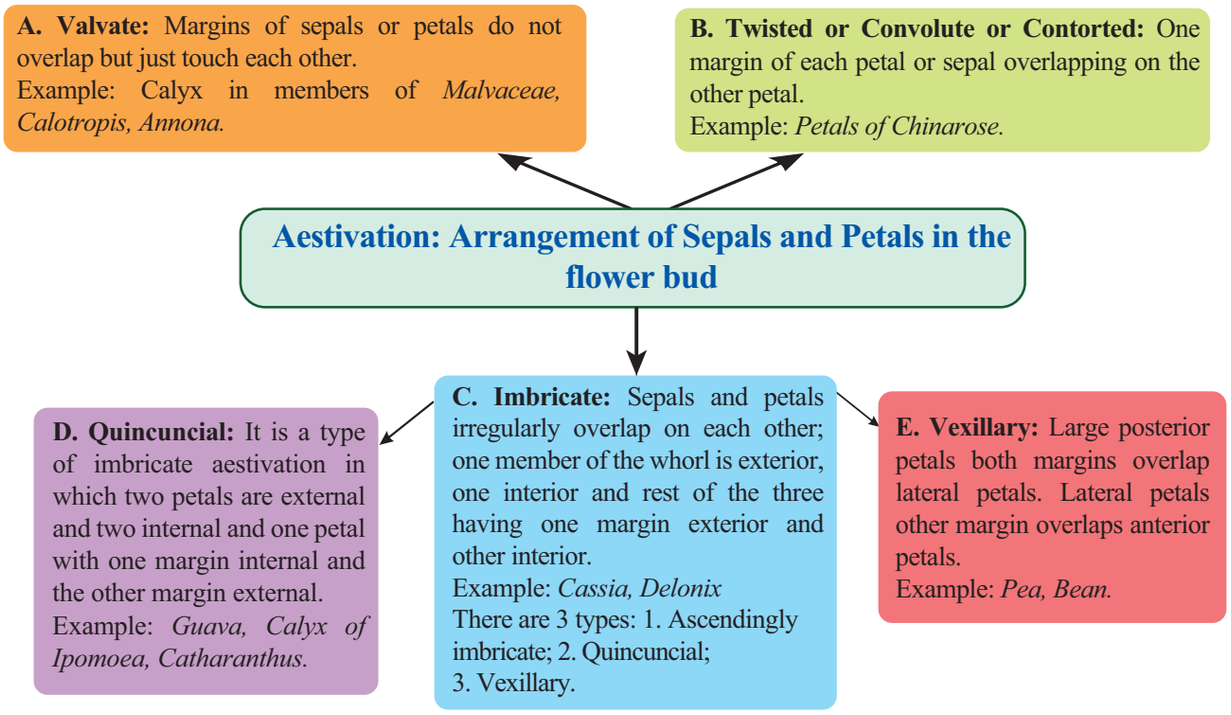


Essential Parts of Flower

4.4 Androecium

Androecium: Third whorl of flower is the male reproductive part of the flower. It is composed of stamens(microsporophylls). Each Stamen consist of 3 parts,

a. Filament b. Anther c. Connective

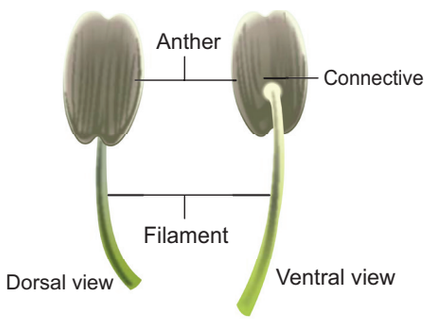


Figure 4.16: Stamen

Anther: Upper swollen part with microsporangia.

Filament: Stalk of stamen

Connective: Tissue connecting anther lobes with filament

Anther typically contains two compartments called **thecae** (singular theca).Each theca consists of two microsporangia.Two microsporangia fused to form a **locule.**

Sterile stamens are called **Staminodes**. Example: *Cassia.* **Distinct:** stamens which do not fuse to one another. **Free:** stamens which do not fuse with other parts of flower. **Apostemonous:** flowers with stamens that are free and distinct.

4.4.1 Fusion of stamens: The fusion of stamens fusing among themselves or with other parts of flower. They are of two types.

1. Connation and 2. Adnation

1. Connation: Refers to the fusion of stamens among themselves. It is of 3 types. **a.** Adelphy. **b.** Syngenecious. **c.** Synandrous.

a. Adelphy: Filaments connate into one or more bundles but anthers are free. It may be the following types.

1. Monadelphous: Filaments of stamens connate into a single bundle.Example: Malvaceae (Chinarose, Cotton).

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